

Ethiopia is currently undergoing a significant digital transformation centered around its new national identity system, known as **Fayda**. This initiative aims to provide a reliable, biometrically-verified identity to all residents, replacing the older, fragmented paper-based ID systems.

What is Fayda?

The **Fayda ID** is a unique 12-digit identification number issued by the **National ID Program (NIDP)**. Unlike the previous "Kelele" (local/kebeles) IDs, Fayda is a centralized, digital-first system inspired by global models like India's Aadhaar. It collects biometric data—specifically **fingerprints** and **iris scans**—along with basic demographic information to ensure that each identity is unique and cannot be duplicated.

Key Features and Benefits

- **Financial Inclusion:** The ID is becoming a mandatory requirement for opening bank accounts, securing loans, and conducting digital transactions. It helps banks fulfill "Know Your Customer" (KYC) requirements instantly.
- **Service Integration:** It serves as a "Primary ID," meaning it can be used for a wide range of public and private services, including getting a driver's license, passport applications, and accessing social safety net programs.
- **Eliminating Duplication:** By using biometrics, the system prevents "ghost" identities, which reduces fraud in government payrolls and aid distribution.
- **Digital Sovereignty:** The system is built on an open-source platform (MOSIP), allowing Ethiopia to customize the technology to fit its specific legal and social needs.

How to Register

The registration process is typically "paperless." Residents visit an enrollment center where their data is captured digitally. Once verified, they receive a physical card or a digital version that can be authenticated online by service providers.

Note: While the Kebele ID has been the standard for decades, the Ethiopian government is gradually transitioning all essential services to require the Fayda ID, making it the most important document for daily life in the country.

Would you like me to find a list of the specific documents you need to bring to a registration center to get your Fayda ID?